

LEONARD “LEN” PEREZ

lenperez@gmail.com | www.lenperez.com | 773 991 6149

A UX leader with 25 years of experience defining, designing, and shipping products across enterprise software, e-commerce, and SaaS platforms. I distill complex workflows into intuitive, human-centered solutions and bring cross-functional teams along through clear storytelling and a collaborative design practice. I understand every stage of the product lifecycle, from early-stage discovery, to design and prototyping, through measurable business outcomes.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer / Lead UX Designer • CDK Global • June 2017 – Oct 2025

CDK Global is a leading SaaS provider for automotive dealership management. Over eight years I moved from UX lead to product design ownership, driving end-to-end solutions across multiple strategic initiatives all while mentoring junior designers and building team culture around communication and craft.

AI-Assisted Communication Tool (Lead Product Designer)

- Led the end-to-end UX definition and design of a centralized communication platform for Sales, Management, and Call Center departments, consolidating all in/outbound customer touch-points (emails, texts, and calls) into a single, unified interface.
- Drove integration of an AI component designed to assist dealership staff throughout the customer's car buying process, including suggested responses, follow-up timing, and conversation prompts. This was done to add meaningful expansion of the product's value proposition.
- Piloted the experience with a defined cohort of dealership users, using structured feedback loops to iterate on the AI interaction model before broader rollout.
- Partnered closely with Product and Engineering, from problem framing through delivery, translating ambiguous requirements into clear design decisions and advocating for the customer experience at each stage of the process.

CRM Redesign (Lead Product Designer)

- Redesigned the top two highest-traffic pages of CDK's CRM used daily by dealership staff: the Opportunity (Customer) Detail Page and the DeskLog (a dashboard highlighting that day's needs). In consolidating fragmented workflows and reducing cognitive load across the entire CRM.
- Conducted heuristic analysis, stakeholder interviews, and workflow mapping to identify friction points before defining the interaction model, ensuring design decisions were grounded in observed behavior rather than assumption.

ML-Powered Service Advisor Tool (Lead UX Designer)

- Collaborated with Product and Engineering to design an application that used machine learning to surface product recommendations for Service Advisors, in real time, to help advisors increase attachment rates without disrupting their workflow.
- Navigated the challenge of making ML actionable to Advisors, designing interface patterns that surfaced confidence signals and recommendations.

Additional Contributions

- Mentored junior designers throughout, providing structured critique, sharing context on business constraints, and helping them develop their ability to communicate design rationale to non-design stakeholders.
- Facilitated an improv-based storytelling workshop for the design team, building business communication and presentation skills through applied, low-stakes practice. This reflected a leadership approach that invests in the whole team, not just the work.

Senior UX Designer • W.W. Grainger • June 2012 – Oct 2014

Grainger is one of the largest industrial supply distributors in North America. I joined a developing UX practice and contributed to industry-leading digital initiatives across web and mobile.

- Redesigned the Selection Guide format for product categories (bulbs, fasteners, and motors). This UX intervention generated more than double the conversion rate across affected categories.
- Designed key segments of the Grainger iPhone and iPad apps, applying existing brand guidelines while incorporating user feedback and research findings to improve find-ability and task completion on mobile systems.
- Awarded a patent for updating the input method of certain forms to allow for quicker entry of data on mobile and tablet devices.
- Collaborated across a multi-disciplinary team of UX architects, developers, product managers, business analysts, researchers, and copywriters to move initiatives from concept to execution at scale.

RELATED EXPERIENCE

Lead UX Designer • Purchasing Platform • 2016

- Led a full redesign of a customer-facing e-commerce site across mobile, tablet, and desktop — from heuristic analysis and competitive benchmarking through persona development, analytics review, and final renderings.

Senior UI Designer • Ricoh – 2015

- Created the Visual/UI Style Guide governing the relauches of Ricoh-USA.com and MyRicoH.com, establishing design standards across two major brand properties.

UX Designer • American Family Insurance (via OgilvyOne) – 2009

- Designed an application that allowed users to customize and configure insurance plans, navigating a complex domain with a consumer-facing simplicity requirement.

Senior UI Designer • Medtronic (via Siren Interactive) – 2009

- Worked with a team to create an interactive, educational, training application for Insulin Pump therapy. Also created a website for the Rare Disease Day community.

UI/UX Designer • FCB (DRAFTFCB / DRAFTWorldWide) – 2006-'07

- On various teams with Creative / Art Directors, copywriters and developers, to create: websites, online advertising, and application prototypes. Clients included: USPS, M&Ms, PACCAR, Wal-Mart, and Body by Milk

Web Designer • IBM – 2000-'01

- Designed and built websites for both internal and external IBM clients; collaborated with fellow designers on multi-part interactive demonstrations using Flash and HTML. Clients included: SteelCase and ManPower

SKILLS

Agile/Lean Processes
Cross-functional Collaboration
Design Thinking
Design Mentorship
Detail Oriented
UX Research
Rapid (AI) Prototyping
Storytelling
Fluent in Spanish
Apple specialist/enthusiast

TOOLS

Adobe Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, XD)
AI (ChatGPT, Claude: Code/Cowork, Gemini, Lovable)
Affinity
Amplitude
Axure
Figma
JustInMind
Keynote
MIRO
PowerPoint
Paper & Pencil

EDUCATION

BFA in Graphic Design • University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign